

Lord, I want to be a Christian

Text: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907
LORD, I WANT TO BE irregular

Music: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907

1 Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart, in my heart.
2 Lord, I want to be more lov-ing...
3 Lord, I want to be more ho-ly...
4 Lord, I want to be like Je-sus...

The first system of the musical score is in 4/4 time with a key signature of one flat (B-flat). It features a treble and bass staff. The melody is primarily in the treble staff, with the bass staff providing harmonic support. The lyrics are aligned with the notes, showing four different phrasings for the first line of the song.

Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.

The second system continues the melody and harmony. It includes a long note in the treble staff for the word 'heart' and a corresponding long note in the bass staff. The lyrics are 'Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.'

In my heart, in my heart,
In my heart, In my heart,

The third system features a more complex melody with a long note in the treble staff for 'heart' and a corresponding long note in the bass staff. The lyrics are 'In my heart, in my heart, In my heart, In my heart,'.

Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.

The fourth system concludes the piece with a final long note in the treble staff for 'heart' and a corresponding long note in the bass staff. The lyrics are 'Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.'